RBT Mock Exam 3: Answer Key

The Stimulus Control Room

Score = number correct out of the 75 scored questions. Questions 5, 16, 30, 35, 47, 58, 67, 73, 78, 84 are unscored pilot questions (shown in gray). They don't count toward your score, but they're still worth reviewing. Use the quick key to check your answer sheet, then review the explanations for any question you missed.

Quick key

1. **D**	18. **A**	35. **C**	52. **B**	69. **A**
2. **A**	19. **B**	36. **B**	53. **A**	70. **B**
3. **C**	20. **A**	37. **A**	54. **D**	71. **C**
4. **B**	21. **C**	38. **A**	55. **D**	72. **A**
5. **D**	22. **C**	39. **C**	56. **C**	73. **D**
6. **A**	23. **D**	40. **C**	57. **D**	74. **C**
7. **C**	24. **B**	41. **A**	58. **D**	75. **B**
8. **B**	25. **A**	42. **B**	59. **A**	76. **D**
9. **A**	26. **C**	43. **D**	60. **A**	77. **B**
10. **C**	27. **D**	44. **D**	61. **C**	78. **A**
11. **D**	28. **C**	45. **A**	62. **A**	79. **C**
12. **D**	29. **D**	46. **D**	63. **A**	80. **A**
13. **D**	30. **B**	47. **C**	64. **B**	81. **A**
14. **B**	31. **A**	48. **D**	65. **C**	82. **B**
15. **B**	32. **C**	49. **D**	66. **B**	83. **C**
16. **B**	33. **C**	50. **C**	67. **B**	84. **B**
17. **B**	34. **D**	51. **B**	68. **D**	85. **A**

Questions by domain

Use this to see which content areas need more study. Pilot questions are marked with an asterisk (*).

Domain	Questions
A. Data Collection and Graphing	2, 7, 14, 16*, 22, 23, 26, 38, 50, 54, 58*, 65, 69, 74, 76
B. Behavior Assessment	15, 29, 30*, 31, 41, 44, 48, 51, 59
C. Behavior Acquisition	8, 9, 12, 24, 27, 28, 32, 33, 34, 36, 39, 46, 47*, 52, 56, 62, 64, 67*, 68, 75, 82

D. Behavior Reduction	1, 4, 6, 10, 17, 18, 25, 40, 42, 55, 73*, 77, 78*, 80, 81, 83
E. Documentation and Reporting	19, 20, 21, 37, 57, 61, 63, 72, 79, 84*, 85
F. Ethics	3, 5*, 11, 13, 35*, 43, 45, 49, 53, 60, 66, 70, 71

Answers and explanations

1. A client engages in self-injury. The plan gives a reinforcer after every 3 minutes with no self-injury. This is:

Correct answer: D. Differential reinforcement of other behavior (DRO)

DRO delivers reinforcement for the absence of the target behavior during an interval. Unlike NCR, reinforcement depends on the behavior not occurring.

Task D.3 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 25: Differential Reinforcement

2. Which is the best operational definition of a tantrum for data collection?

Correct answer: A. Crying, screaming, or dropping to the floor for 5 or more seconds; ends after 30 seconds without these behaviors

A strong definition names the observable behaviors and gives onset and offset criteria. That tells every observer exactly when to start and stop counting or timing. The other options depend on each observer's judgment.

Task A.5 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 3: Selecting and Defining Target Behaviors

3. Which supervision arrangement is NOT allowed under the RBT Ethics Code?

Correct answer: C. The RBT employs their own supervisor

RBTs can't be employers of their supervisors, since that creates a conflict of interest that undermines objective oversight.

Task F.3 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 1.04

4. A client often refuses tasks. The plan lets him choose the order of his tasks. Which type of intervention is this?

Correct answer: B. Antecedent intervention

Offering choices changes the conditions before behavior and can reduce the motivation to escape. It's a simple, effective antecedent strategy.

Task D.2 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 26: Antecedent Interventions

5. In a small town, a client's parent is also your child's teacher. The relationship can't be avoided. What reduces the risk? PILOT · UNSCORED

Correct answer: D. Tell your supervisor, keep interactions professional in each role, and document the plan

Some multiple relationships are unavoidable. The key is disclosure to your supervisor, clear boundaries, and documentation, so neither relationship affects the other.

Task F.7 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 1.10

6. Why is it important to identify the function of a behavior before choosing an intervention?

Correct answer: A. Interventions matched to function are more likely to work

An intervention that doesn't address why the behavior happens may fail or even make it worse. For example, time-out for escape-maintained behavior gives the client exactly what they want.

Task D.1 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 27: Functional Behavior Assessment

7. Why should data be entered and graphs updated promptly after each session?

Correct answer: C. So the supervisor can make timely, data-based decisions about treatment

Graphs are how your supervisor sees progress or problems. Up-to-date graphs mean faster decisions, like moving a mastered target or changing a procedure that isn't working.

Task A.4 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 6: Constructing and Interpreting Graphic Displays of Behavioral Data

8. Your supervisor asks you to intersperse mastered targets with new targets during DTT. What is the main purpose?

Correct answer: B. To keep reinforcement high and maintain the client's motivation

Mixing easy, mastered targets with harder new ones gives the client more chances to succeed and contact reinforcement, which supports motivation and cooperation.

Task C.3 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 17: Stimulus Control

9. After a skill is learned with continuous reinforcement, why would your supervisor thin the schedule?

Correct answer: A. To help the behavior maintain and resemble natural contingencies

Intermittent reinforcement makes behavior more resistant to extinction and more like real life, where not every response gets reinforced. Thinning should be gradual.

Task C.1 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 13: Schedules of Reinforcement

10. A client covers her ears and screams during loud school assemblies. The plan has her wear noise-reducing headphones before assemblies start. This is an example of:

Correct answer: C. Modifying the antecedent to reduce the motivation for problem behavior

Providing headphones before the assembly reduces how aversive the noise is, so the motivation for escape-maintained screaming drops. It's a proactive antecedent change.

Task D.2 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 26: Antecedent Interventions

11. During a home session, you see signs that suggest a client may be experiencing abuse. What should you do?

Correct answer: D. Follow mandated reporting laws and agency policy, and notify your supervisor

Confidentiality has legal limits, and protecting a client from harm is one of them. Follow mandated reporting requirements, notify your supervisor, and document per policy.

Task F.5 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.01; BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.07

12. What is the main goal of errorless learning procedures?

Correct answer: D. To minimize errors while the client learns a new skill

Errorless learning uses carefully planned prompts (such as most-to-least or 0-second time delay) so the client responds correctly from the start. Prompts are then faded to independence.

Task C.7 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 17: Stimulus Control

13. A family offers to buy you lunch ($15) every Friday as thanks. Your employer has no gift policy. What should you do?

Correct answer: D. Politely decline, since this exceeds the gift limit in the RBT Ethics Code

Each lunch exceeds the $10 limit and would be a recurring financial benefit. Decline politely and thank the family for the thought.

Task F.8 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 1.11

14. A client eats very quickly and sometimes chokes. The goal is to increase the time between bites. Which measure is most useful?

Correct answer: B. Interresponse time (IRT)

The goal is about the time between two successive responses (bites), so IRT is the most direct measure. Latency starts from a stimulus or instruction, not from the previous response.

Task A.1 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 4: Measuring Behavior

15. In a functional analysis, what is the purpose of the play (control) condition?

Correct answer: B. To provide a comparison condition with free access to attention and toys and no demands

The play condition has no motivating operations for problem behavior (attention and toys are freely available, no demands). Rates in the test conditions are compared against it.

Task B.3 (Behavior Assessment). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 27: Functional Behavior Assessment

16. During intervention for self-injury, which data pattern would show that the intervention is working as intended? PILOT · UNSCORED

Correct answer: B. A decreasing trend in self-injury across sessions

For a behavior targeted for reduction, a decreasing trend is the desired direction. If the data stay at baseline or become highly variable, let your supervisor know.

Task A.7 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 6: Constructing and Interpreting Graphic Displays of Behavioral Data

17. Why must extinction be applied consistently by all caregivers and staff?

Correct answer: B. Inconsistent use can reinforce the behavior intermittently, making it harder to reduce

When some people withhold reinforcement and others don't, the behavior ends up on an intermittent schedule, which makes it more persistent. Everyone needs to be on the same page.

Task D.4 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 24: Extinction

18. A client climbs on shelves. Each time, a caregiver firmly says "No!" Climbing decreases. The reprimand functioned as:

Correct answer: A. Positive punishment

A stimulus (the reprimand) was added after the behavior, and the behavior decreased. That's positive punishment. For some clients, though, reprimands function as attention and increase behavior. Function is determined by the effect.

Task D.5 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 14: Positive Punishment

19. You realize that for the past week you have been running a procedure incorrectly. What should you do?

Correct answer: B. Tell your supervisor right away and ask for retraining

Your supervisor needs to know, since the data from last week may reflect the incorrect procedure. Reporting it right away and asking for retraining shows integrity. Changing data is falsification.

Task E.2 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 3.02; BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.02; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

20. A client started attending a new daycare this week, and you notice more crying in sessions. What is the best action?

Correct answer: A. Document both the daycare change and the crying data, and report them to your supervisor

New settings and routines can affect behavior. Reporting both the variable and the data lets your supervisor consider the connection. Recommendations belong to your supervisor.

Task E.3 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.02; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

21. A session was scheduled for 2:00 to 4:00, but it started at 2:20. What times should you document?

Correct answer: C. The actual start and end times of the session

Session documentation must reflect what actually happened. Recording scheduled instead of actual times misrepresents services and can be considered fraud.

Task E.4 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.02; BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 1.01; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

22. Session 1: 30 responses in 60 minutes. Session 2: 15 responses in 20 minutes. Which session had the higher rate?

Correct answer: C. Session 2 (0.75 per minute)

Rate = count ÷ time. Session 1: 30 ÷ 60 = 0.5 per minute. Session 2: 15 ÷ 20 = 0.75 per minute. Session 2 had fewer total responses but a higher rate, which is why raw counts can mislead when session lengths differ.

Task A.6 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 4: Measuring Behavior

23. What is a key advantage of permanent product recording?

Correct answer: D. The behavior can be measured after it occurs, without observing it directly

Permanent product lets you measure outcomes (completed worksheets, made beds) after the fact, which frees you from watching continuously. It only works for behaviors that leave a lasting result, though.

Task A.3 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 4: Measuring Behavior

24. What is a main advantage of backward chaining?

Correct answer: B. The client completes the last step and contacts the terminal reinforcer on every trial

In backward chaining, the client always finishes the chain, so every trial ends with completing the task and getting reinforced. That can speed learning.

Task C.5 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 23: Chaining

25. A client screams to get candy at the store. What would extinction look like?

Correct answer: A. Not providing the candy when the client screams

Extinction withholds the reinforcer that maintains the behavior, which here is the candy. Scolding adds attention, and leaving the store may give escape.

Task D.4 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 24: Extinction

26. Using 10-second whole-interval recording, a client is on-task for the first 8 seconds of an interval and then looks away. How is that interval scored?

Correct answer: C. Not scored

Whole-interval requires the behavior for the entire interval. Eight of 10 seconds isn't enough, so the interval isn't scored. This is how whole-interval underestimates behavior.

Task A.2 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 4: Measuring Behavior

27. During snack time, you hold up the juice box and wait for the client to say "juice" before giving it. What type of teaching is this?

Correct answer: D. Naturalistic teaching of a mand (request)

Teaching happens during a natural routine, the client's motivation (wanting juice) drives the response, and the reinforcer is the item requested. That's a mand taught naturalistically.

Task C.4 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 18: Verbal Behavior

28. You place the correct picture closer to the client than the other pictures. What type of prompt is this?

Correct answer: C. A positional (stimulus) prompt

Changing where the stimulus is placed is a stimulus prompt, specifically a positional one. Physical, verbal, and model prompts are response prompts, meaning help from you.

Task C.7 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 17: Stimulus Control

29. Your supervisor asks you to help reassess a client's skills before a treatment plan update. Why is reassessment done?

Correct answer: D. To measure progress and identify new goals

Periodic skill reassessment shows what the client has learned and what's next. It gives your supervisor the information needed to update goals.

Task B.2 (Behavior Assessment). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 3: Selecting and Defining Target Behaviors

30. In a functional analysis, which condition is designed to test for automatic reinforcement?

PILOT · UNSCORED

Correct answer: B. Alone or no-interaction condition

When the client is alone or no one interacts with them, there are no social consequences. If behavior persists there, automatic reinforcement is likely.

Task B.3 (Behavior Assessment). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 27: Functional Behavior Assessment

31. In a paired stimulus assessment, why do you alternate which side (left or right) each item appears on?

Correct answer: A. To control for a side bias so choices reflect preference, not position

Some clients tend to pick whatever is on one side. Alternating positions keeps a side bias from masking true preferences.

Task B.1 (Behavior Assessment). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 11: Positive Reinforcement

32. What is a main advantage of naturalistic teaching approaches?

Correct answer: C. Skills are more likely to generalize to everyday settings

Because teaching happens in natural contexts with natural reinforcers, skills are more likely to carry over to real life. Data collection and reinforcement are still part of it.

Task C.4 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 30: Generalization and Maintenance of Behavior Change

33. Which describes an acquisition procedure?

Correct answer: C. Teaching a new target with prompts and a dense reinforcement schedule

Acquisition is teaching something new, which usually means more support, more practice, and more reinforcement. The other choices describe maintenance of skills already learned.

Task C.9 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 30: Generalization and Maintenance of Behavior Change

34. A client says "Hi!" and hugs everyone, including strangers in the store. What does your supervisor likely need to teach?

Correct answer: D. Discrimination between familiar people and strangers

The response has generalized too broadly. Discrimination training teaches the client that some situations (familiar people) are the SD for hugging, while others (strangers) are not.

Task C.6 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 17: Stimulus Control

35. You notice you are judging a family's parenting style because it differs from how you were raised. What reflects cultural humility? PILOT · UNSCORED

Correct answer: C. Recognize the bias, reflect on it, and discuss it with your supervisor

Cultural humility starts with noticing your own biases. Talking with your supervisor helps you deliver services that respect the family's values.

Task F.10 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 1.07

36. The client learned to ask for help using a specific picture card at the clinic. Your supervisor asks you to bring that same card to home sessions. Which generalization strategy is this?

Correct answer: B. Programming common stimuli

Programming common stimuli means including features of the training setting in the new setting (or the reverse), so the new setting shares cues that support the skill.

Task C.8 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 30: Generalization and Maintenance of Behavior Change

37. A parent tells you the family will be moving to a new home next month. What should you do?

Correct answer: A. Document it and let your supervisor know

Major life changes like moving can affect behavior and scheduling. Report them so your supervisor can plan and interpret data in context.

Task E.3 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.02; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

38. A client's data across 7 sessions are 5, 6, 5, 5, 6, 5, 5. How would you describe the data?

Correct answer: A. Stable

The data stay within a narrow range (5 to 6) with no upward or downward direction. That's stable responding. Stable baselines help your supervisor judge the effects of an intervention.

Task A.7 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 6: Constructing and Interpreting Graphic Displays of Behavioral Data

39. Which is an example of an unconditioned reinforcer?

Correct answer: C. Water for a thirsty client

Unconditioned reinforcers work without prior learning because they relate to biological needs (water, food, warmth). Stickers, praise, and tokens are conditioned. They get their value through pairing.

Task C.2 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 11: Positive Reinforcement

40. A client scratches a mosquito bite, which temporarily relieves the itch. What function does scratching serve?

Correct answer: C. Automatic negative reinforcement

Scratching removes an unpleasant sensation (itch) without anyone else involved. Removal by the behavior itself means automatic negative reinforcement.

Task D.1 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 27: Functional Behavior Assessment

41. Before a trial-based preference assessment, what is a common step?

Correct answer: A. Let the client briefly sample each item

Brief sampling makes sure the client has contacted each item before choosing, so choices reflect preference and not unfamiliarity.

Task B.1 (Behavior Assessment). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 11: Positive Reinforcement

42. A student reinforced only when at least 10 minutes have passed since her last trip to the pencil sharpener is being taught with:

Correct answer: B. Spaced-responding DRL

Spaced-responding DRL reinforces a response only if a minimum time has passed since the last one. It lowers the rate of a behavior that's fine in moderation.

Task D.3 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 25: Differential Reinforcement

43. You and a coworker are at a busy coffee shop discussing a difficult client by first name. What is the problem?

Correct answer: D. Others could overhear confidential client information

Confidentiality applies everywhere. Discussing clients in public, even by first name, risks disclosure. Save those conversations for private, work-appropriate settings.

Task F.5 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.08

44. In a free operant preference assessment, what do you record?

Correct answer: D. How much time the client spends engaged with each freely available item

Free operant assessments give continuous access to all items and measure engagement time. More time spent suggests higher preference.

Task B.1 (Behavior Assessment). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 11: Positive Reinforcement

45. Your new supervisor is also your roommate. What should you do?

Correct answer: A. Inform agency management and document efforts to address the multiple relationship

A personal relationship with your supervisor is a multiple relationship that can affect objectivity. When the conflict involves your supervisor, the code directs you to go to management (or the BACB) and document the steps taken.

Task F.7 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 1.10

46. On a fixed interval 2-minute (FI 2) schedule, when is reinforcement delivered?

Correct answer: D. For the first response after 2 minutes have passed

An FI schedule reinforces the first response after a fixed time has passed. Reinforcement every 2 minutes regardless of behavior would be a fixed-time (noncontingent) schedule. An average of 2 minutes is a variable interval.

Task C.1 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 13: Schedules of Reinforcement

47. Your client has been earning a break after 3 tokens for several weeks and is doing well. What change might your supervisor make next? PILOT · UNSCORED

Correct answer: C. Gradually increase the number of tokens required for exchange

Thinning a token economy, by gradually requiring more tokens or delaying exchange, builds tolerance for delayed reinforcement and moves toward natural conditions.

Task C.11 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 28: Token Economy, Group Contingencies, and Contingency Contracting

48. What is a main advantage of the MSWO preference assessment compared to the paired stimulus format?

Correct answer: D. It produces a preference ranking in less time

MSWO produces a ranking in fewer trials than paired stimulus, which pairs every item with every other item. That efficiency is why MSWO is used so often in practice.

Task B.1 (Behavior Assessment). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 11: Positive Reinforcement

49. Which action best reflects the core principle of benefiting others?

Correct answer: D. Prioritizing the client's welfare when making decisions

Benefiting others means acting in the client's best interest. When a decision is unclear, ask: what serves the client's welfare? Then check with your supervisor.

Task F.1 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.01

50. Your supervisor wants to know how long a client stays in the bathroom each time he goes. Which measure should you use?

Correct answer: C. Duration per occurrence

"How long each time" calls for duration per occurrence: time each episode from start to end. Total duration would combine all trips into one number and hide what each trip looked like.

Task A.1 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 4: Measuring Behavior

51. Which ABC entry is written objectively?

Correct answer: B. A: Teacher said "Clean up." B: Client threw blocks. C: Teacher said "Okay, I'll do it."

Objective ABC data describe exactly what was said and done, so your supervisor can find patterns. Words like "annoyed," "defiant," or "gave in" are interpretations.

Task B.3 (Behavior Assessment). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 27: Functional Behavior Assessment

52. A client earns a 2-minute break from work after completing 3 problems, and problem completion increases. What type of reinforcement is this?

Correct answer: B. Negative reinforcement

Removing the work (a break) after the target behavior, followed by an increase in that behavior, is negative reinforcement. Planned breaks for work completion are a common, appropriate use of it.

Task C.1 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 12: Negative Reinforcement

53. How should an RBT's competence to implement a procedure be established?

Correct answer: A. The supervisor observes the RBT and confirms correct implementation

Competence is shown through performance and confirmed by your supervisor, often through observation and feedback. Feeling confident or reading about it isn't enough.

Task F.2 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 1.06

54. Why should you record the length of the observation period along with your frequency count?

Correct answer: D. So the count can be converted to a rate and compared across sessions of different lengths

Ten responses in 10 minutes and ten responses in 2 hours are very different. Recording the observation time lets your supervisor calculate rate (count ÷ time), so sessions of different lengths can be compared fairly.

Task A.1 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 4: Measuring Behavior

55. A child hits his sibling, and the TV is turned off for 5 minutes. Hitting decreases. This is an example of:

Correct answer: D. Negative punishment

A preferred activity (TV) was removed contingent on hitting, and hitting decreased. Removal plus decrease equals negative punishment.

Task D.5 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 15: Negative Punishment

56. A client says "cookie" when shown a cookie, but not when shown a cracker. This shows that saying "cookie" is:

Correct answer: C. Under stimulus control

When a response occurs reliably with one stimulus and not with others, it's under stimulus control. That's the goal of discrimination training.

Task C.6 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 17: Stimulus Control

57. A school aide tells you that your client has started a new behavior at school. What should you do?

Correct answer: D. Share the report with your supervisor in a timely manner

Reports from other team members give your supervisor a fuller picture. Pass them on promptly. Your supervisor decides whether an assessment or intervention is needed.

Task E.1 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.06; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

58. Your supervisor collects data at the same time as you to calculate interobserver agreement (IOA). What is the main purpose? PILOT · UNSCORED

Correct answer: D. To check whether the data are being recorded consistently and reliably

IOA checks whether two observers record the same thing. Low agreement signals unclear definitions or inconsistent recording, and decisions based on unreliable data can harm the client.

Task A.8 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 5: Improving and Assessing the Quality of Behavioral Measurement

59. During a skills assessment, the client is unusually tired and refuses many items. What should you do?

Correct answer: A. Follow the assessment instructions and note the client's condition for your supervisor

Conditions like fatigue or illness can affect results. Record according to the assessment's rules and document what you observed, so your supervisor can decide whether to retest.

Task B.2 (Behavior Assessment). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 18: Verbal Behavior

60. Before using a new procedure with a client, your supervisor has you practice it with her while she gives feedback. Which part of behavioral skills training is this?

Correct answer: A. Rehearsal

In behavioral skills training, rehearsal is when you practice the skill, usually through role-play, while your supervisor gives feedback. It comes after instructions and modeling.

Task F.4 (Ethics). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 31: Ethical and Professional Responsibilities of Applied Behavior Analysts

61. A client's grandmother tells you she gives him candy whenever he cries so he'll calm down. What should you do?

Correct answer: C. Tell your supervisor, since this may affect the client's behavior and the plan

Caregiver practices can strongly affect behavior. Relay this to your supervisor, who can decide on caregiver training. Stay respectful and don't take on the BCBA's role.

Task E.1 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.06; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

62. Using total task chaining for toothbrushing, the client does steps 1 to 3 independently but needs help with step 4. What should you do?

Correct answer: A. Prompt only step 4, then let the client continue with the remaining steps

In total task chaining, you give only as much help as needed on each step. Prompting steps the client already does independently creates unnecessary dependence.

Task C.5 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 23: Chaining

63. You disagree with a procedure your supervisor has written, but it poses no immediate safety risk. What should you do first?

Correct answer: A. Discuss your concern respectfully with your supervisor

Following the chain of command means going to your supervisor first. If a concern isn't resolved and involves ethics or safety, you can take it further, starting with agency leadership.

Task E.2 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.06; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

64. During DTT, when is the best time to record data for each trial?

Correct answer: B. Right after the trial, during the intertrial interval

Recording during the intertrial interval keeps data accurate. Waiting until later relies on memory, which leads to errors.

Task C.3 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 17: Stimulus Control

65. Using 10-second partial-interval recording, a client throws an item three separate times within one interval. How is that interval scored?

Correct answer: C. As one scored interval

Partial-interval asks only whether the behavior occurred in the interval, not how many times. Three throws in one interval is still one scored interval. That's why interval data don't give you an exact count.

Task A.2 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 4: Measuring Behavior

66. Your agency posts a video of a client's progress on its website with written consent. Can you share it on your personal social media?

Correct answer: B. No, because RBTs must not share client identifying information on their own social media

The code prohibits RBTs from sharing client identifying information, including photos and videos, on social media. An agency's consent for its own site doesn't extend to your personal accounts.

Task F.6 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.09

67. During shaping, what happens to previous approximations once the client reliably produces the next approximation? PILOT · UNSCORED

Correct answer: B. They are no longer reinforced

Shaping uses differential reinforcement. The new, closer approximation is reinforced, and earlier approximations are placed on extinction. That's what moves behavior toward the target.

Task C.10 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 22: Shaping

68. In progressive time delay, how does the delay change?

Correct answer: D. The time between the instruction and the prompt gradually increases across trials

Progressive time delay starts at 0 seconds and gradually lengthens the wait before the prompt, giving the client more chances to respond independently. Constant time delay uses one fixed delay.

Task C.7 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 17: Stimulus Control

69. A client independently completed 5 of 8 steps in a handwashing task analysis. What percentage of steps were completed independently?

Correct answer: A. 62.5%

Percentage = (independent steps ÷ total steps) × 100 = 5 ÷ 8 × 100 = 62.5%. Your supervisor may compare this percentage across sessions to track progress on the whole chain.

Task A.6 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 4: Measuring Behavior

70. During a parent meeting, what best demonstrates active listening?

Correct answer: B. Summarizing the parent's concerns back to them to confirm understanding

Active listening means paying full attention and checking your understanding, for example by paraphrasing. It builds trust and makes sure concerns get passed on accurately.

Task F.9 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.03

71. Which job title on an RBT's professional profile is accurate?

Correct answer: C. Registered Behavior Technician (RBT)

Represent your credential exactly as it is. Titles implying licensure or BCBA certification that you don't hold are misrepresentation.

Task F.6 (Ethics). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 1.05

72. A parent asks you to do a procedure differently than the behavior plan states. What should you do?

Correct answer: A. Continue following the plan and contact your supervisor about the parent's request

RBTs implement the plan as written and send questions to the supervisor. Politely explain that you'll share the request, and follow the chain of command.

Task E.2 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.02; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

73. Which is the most appropriate way to document a crisis incident? PILOT · UNSCORED

Correct answer: D. Describe what happened before, during, and after the incident in objective, observable terms

Incident documentation should be objective and complete (antecedents, behaviors, procedures used, and outcomes) and done promptly per policy. Your supervisor relies on it.

Task D.7 (Behavior Reduction). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.02; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

74. Which target behavior passes the "dead man's test" (something a dead man could not do)?

Correct answer: C. Raising a hand to request help

If a dead man could do it, it isn't behavior. "Not hitting," "staying quiet," and "not leaving the seat" describe the absence of action. Raising a hand is an active, observable behavior you can teach and measure.

Task A.5 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 3: Selecting and Defining Target Behaviors

75. A client says "mmm" to request more. You have been reinforcing "mmm." Using shaping, what should you reinforce next?

Correct answer: B. A closer approximation, such as "mo"

Shaping moves one small step at a time. Jumping straight to "more" risks extinction and frustration. "Mo" is the next reasonable approximation.

Task C.10 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 22: Shaping

76. A client's vocal stereotypy occurs at a very high rate, and you are running other programs at the same time. Which method will most likely give usable data with the least disruption?

Correct answer: D. Momentary time sampling

Counting or timing every instance of a high-rate behavior while teaching is nearly impossible. Momentary time sampling only requires a quick look at the end of each interval. Your supervisor picks the method, but that's the reasoning behind it.

Task A.2 (Data Collection and Graphing). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 4: Measuring Behavior

77. A client now asks for attention appropriately using FCT but asks every few seconds. Your supervisor plans to gradually teach the client to wait before attention is given. Why?

Correct answer: B. To thin the reinforcement schedule to a level caregivers can maintain

Right after FCT is established, reinforcing every request may not be practical. Schedule thinning, such as adding a delay or using signals, makes the intervention workable in real life.

Task D.3 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 25: Differential Reinforcement

78. A child who is often spanked at home starts hitting peers at school. Which side effect of punishment does this illustrate? PILOT · UNSCORED

Correct answer: A. Modeling of punishment

People who experience punishment may imitate it. This modeling effect is one reason ABA puts reinforcement-based procedures first.

Task D.6 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 14: Positive Punishment

79. Which is the best objective rewrite of "The client was defiant during work"?

Correct answer: C. The client said "No" and pushed materials away after 4 of 6 instructions

"Defiant" is a label. The objective version describes exactly what the client said and did and how often. That's what your supervisor needs.

Task E.4 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.02; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

80. When extinction begins for a client's attention-maintained whining, he also starts hitting. This is an example of:

Correct answer: A. Extinction-induced aggression

Extinction can produce emotional behavior and aggression, especially early on. Your supervisor should plan for these secondary effects. Report them and follow the plan.

Task D.6 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 24: Extinction

81. A client becomes aggressive toward peers. The crisis plan calls for a physical hold, but you have not been trained in it. What should you do?

Correct answer: A. Use approved non-physical strategies from the plan, such as moving peers away, and get trained staff

Never use a restrictive procedure you're not trained in. It can injure the client or you. Use approved alternatives, keep everyone safe, and call for trained help.

Task D.7 (Behavior Reduction). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.05

82. To establish praise as a conditioned reinforcer, how should it be paired with an existing reinforcer?

Correct answer: B. Deliver praise immediately before or with the established reinforcer

For pairing to work, the neutral stimulus should predict the reinforcer, meaning it comes right before or with it. Over repeated pairings, praise takes on reinforcing value.

Task C.2 (Behavior Acquisition). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 11: Positive Reinforcement

83. A client runs out of the bathroom every time he is asked to brush his teeth, and the toothbrushing is dropped. What is the most likely function?

Correct answer: C. Escape

The behavior ends the unwanted task, which points to escape. Your supervisor would confirm with assessment data before writing an intervention.

Task D.1 (Behavior Reduction). Source: Cooper, Heron, & Heward (2020). Applied Behavior Analysis (3rd ed.), Ch. 27: Functional Behavior Assessment

84. Which is an example of meeting workplace requirements for session documentation?

PILOT · UNSCORED

Correct answer: B. Using the agency's required note template and submitting it by the deadline

Agencies set documentation requirements to meet legal and payer rules. Following the template and timelines is part of your professional responsibility.

Task E.4 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.02; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)

85. A parent asks you to start working on toilet training during sessions. What is the appropriate response?

Correct answer: A. Tell the parent you will pass the request to your supervisor

Adding new goals is your supervisor's decision. Acknowledge the request and pass it on. Starting on your own or dismissing it both skip the proper process.

Task E.1 (Documentation and Reporting). Source: BACB RBT Ethics Code (2.0), Standard 2.06; BACB RBT Test Content Outline (3rd ed.)